

SIPRA DAS



FULL CIRCLE:
Amar flanked
by Sonia and
Manmohan in
May 2004

The man who likes super cars and gold Rolex Oyster is at home in political netherlands as well as in champagne evenings. And now he is at the centre of a political thriller with a nuclear dimension. He thinks he alone can ensure a place for the badly mauled Manmohan Singh in history—and stop the Sovietisation of the republic. Only this man can save the nuclear deal and the Government—that's what he believes and a desperate Congress hopes.

Look where he is and where he has been. So many reputations were at stake when he made his move. By withdrawing support to the UPA Government, Prakash Karat, the CPI(M) boss in his Stalinist make-believe, has abandoned the secular

project for the higher cause of anti-imperialism, no matter however redundant an ism that is. The prime minister, at last, has told the nation that he is not the weakest, no matter what L.K. Advani may call him now. Come Tuesday and you will see Ram Rajya and the Soviet Rajya united by, well, national interest. For Amar Singh, though, it has been yet another moment of transition in a life that has been a political picaresque. Suddenly, the forbidding gates of 10 Janpath opened for the general secretary of the Samajwadi Party, who for the Gandhis was Evil Incarnate till the other day. It was Sonia Gandhi who sent out an sos and Amar Singh and his boss Mulayam Singh Yadav obliged. The untouchable became the indispensable, and it was no mean achievement in acceptability.

This new-found elevation to the country's most coveted durbar was on display last week when Amar Singh and Rahul Gandhi met for over two hours at an undisclosed location. It was not certainly a meeting of the minds but two disparate politicians—the potential kingmaker and the

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